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Chapter One

Introduction

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Chapter One

Introduction

1.1 Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) of National Statistical Office (NSO)

1.1.1 Considering the importance of availability of labour force data at more frequent time intervals, National Statistical Office (NSO) launched Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) on April 2017.

The objective of PLFS is primarily twofold:

- to estimate the key employment and unemployment indicators (viz. Worker Population Ratio, Labour Force Participation Rate, Unemployment Rate) in the short time interval of three months for the urban areas only in the Current Weekly Status (CWS)
- to estimate employment and unemployment indicators in both usual status (ps+ss) and CWS in both rural and urban areas annually.

The first Annual Report (July 2017– June 2018) on the basis of Periodic Labour Force Survey covering both rural and urban areas giving estimates of all important parameters of employment and unemployment in both usual status (ps+ss) and current weekly status (CWS) was released on May 2019 and the second Annual Report (July 2018-June 2019) was released on June 2020. This is the third Annual Report being brought out by NSO on the basis of Periodic Labour Force Survey conducted during July 2019-June 2020.

1.2 PLFS fieldwork during COVID-19 pandemic

1.2.1 The fieldwork of PLFS was suspended from 18.03.2020 due to COVID-19 pandemic. The fieldwork of the pending FSUs for January - March 2020 and the field work of FSUs allotted for canvassing during April – June, 2020 were resumed on 1st June 2020. Although schedules were canvassed later, the information was asked with respect to the actual reference period which would have been adopted if there were no pandemic. Thus, there was no break in the flow of information collected for any quarter except that informants were approached at a later date due to the unavoidable situation. On resumption of fieldwork in June 2020, the field officials were advised that the canvassing of revisit schedules was to be undertaken telephonically, as per actual reference periods of samples, in the original paper revisit schedules. The telephonic mode was adopted for revisit Schedules in order to minimise the physical interaction with informants so as to contain spread of COVID virus and to cope up with pandemic related restrictions

1.3 Geographical coverage of PLFS

1.3.1 *Geographical coverage:* The survey covered the whole of the Indian Union *except* the villages in Andaman and Nicobar Islands which remained extremely difficult to access throughout the year.

1.4 Sample Design of PLFS

1.4.1 A rotational panel sampling design has been used in urban areas. In this rotational panel scheme each selected household in urban areas is visited four times – in the beginning with first visit schedule and thrice periodically later with revisit schedule. In urban area, samples for a panel within each stratum were drawn in the form of two independent sub-samples. There was no revisit in the rural samples. For rural areas, samples for a stratum/sub-stratum were drawn randomly in the form of two independent sub-samples. For rural areas, in each quarter of the survey period, 25% FSUs of annual allocation were covered.

1.4.2 A stratified multi-stage design was adopted for PLFS. The first stage units (FSU) were the Urban Frame Survey (UFS) blocks in urban areas and 2011 Population Census villages (Panchayat wards for Kerala) in rural areas. The ultimate stage units (USU) were households. In the case of large FSUs one intermediate stage unit, called hamlet group/sub-block, were formed.

1.4.3 In urban areas, strata were formed within each NSS region on the basis of size class of towns as per Population Census 2011. The rural areas, each NSS region constituted rural stratum. In case of rural sectors of Nagaland, a special stratum was formed within the State consisting of all the villages which were difficult to access.

In urban areas there was no sub-stratification. In rural areas, 'r/8' sub-strata were formed in each rural stratum, if 'r' was the annual sample size allocated for a rural stratum. The villages within a stratum as per frame were first arranged in ascending order of population. Then sub-strata 1 to 'r/8' were demarcated in such a way that each sub-stratum comprised a group of villages of the arranged frame and had more or less equal population.

1.4.4 At all-India level a total of 12,800 FSUs (7,024 villages and 5,776 UFS blocks) were allotted for survey annually. State/UT level samples were allocated between two sectors in proportion to population as per Census 2011 with double weightage to urban sector in general. Within each sector of a State/UT, the respective sample size was allocated to the different strata (in the case of urban areas) and strata/ sub-strata (in the case of rural areas) in proportion to the population as per Census 2011. Urban allocations at stratum level were adjusted to multiples of 8 with a minimum sample size of 8 (for 4 panels, each of size multiple of 2). Rural allocation for each stratum was also multiple of 8 with minimum sample size of 8 (for 4 quarters, each of size 2).

1.4.5 Urban FSUs were selected by probability proportional to size with replacement (PPSWR) scheme, size being the number of households in the UFS block. Samples for a panel within each stratum were drawn in the form of two independent sub-samples. To implement the rotational scheme, 4 groups of sample FSUs of equal size (each multiple of size 2, half for each of sub-sample 1 and sub-sample 2) were drawn randomly. In the rural areas, samples for a stratum/sub-stratum were drawn randomly in the form of two independent sub-samples with probability proportional to size with replacement (PPSWR) scheme, size being the population of the village and equal number of samples were allocated among the four quarters. All households listed in a village/UFS block where no hamlet-group/sub-block formation was done, or the households listed in the two selected hamlet-groups/sub-blocks of the village/UFS block where hamlet-group/sub-block formation was

done, constituted the sampling frame of households. All the households listed in the selected village/ hamlet-groups were stratified into three second stage strata (SSS) and all the households listed in the selected UFS block /sub-blocks were stratified into four second stage strata (SSS). A total of 8 households were selected from each sample village/block for canvassing the detailed schedule. The sample households from each of the second stage strata were selected by SRSWOR.

1.4.6 The domains of rural and urban sector in the survey are co-terminus with the criterion adopted in census. The urban frame used in the survey was the latest updated UFS that took into account the newly declared towns after the last census 2011. Accordingly the rural sector is the one that is not urban.

1.5 Sample Size

1.5.1 Sample Size for First Visit during July 2019- June 2020 in rural and urban areas:

Out of the total number of 12,800 FSUs (7,024 villages and 5,776 UFS blocks) allotted for the survey at the all-India level during July 2019- June 2020, a total of 12,569 FSUs (6,913 villages and 5,656 urban blocks) could be surveyed for canvassing the PLFS schedule (Schedule 10.4). The number of households surveyed was 1,00,480 (55,291 in rural areas and 45,189 in urban areas) and number of persons surveyed was 4,18,297 (2,40,231 in rural areas and 1,78,066 in urban areas).

1.5.2 Sample Size in urban areas in each of the quarter of survey period July 2019- June 2020:

In urban areas a rotational panel sampling design was used and in this rotational panel scheme each selected household in urban areas is visited four times – one with first visit schedule and other three with revisit schedule. In rural areas there was no revisit. In the Table below, the sample size in terms of FSU (UFS block), households and persons in urban areas is given, separately for each of the quarter of the survey period July 2019- June 2020.

Table 1: Sample size in urban areas in each of the quarter of Survey period July 2019- June 2020			
Survey Period	FSU (UFS blocks)	household	person
July - Sept 2019	5,723	45,288	1,79,422
Oct - Dec 2019	5,720	44,471	1,76,310
Jan - Mar 2020	5,722	45,555	1,79,838
April- June 2020	5,651	43,971	1,73,203
Please refer to the data reference given in Table 2 of this Chapter.			

1.6 Data reference and survey period of the Annual Report of Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS), 2019-20

1.6.1 The results of the Annual Report of PLFS, 2019-20 are generated from the data collected during the four quarters of the survey period: July-September 2019, October-December 2019, January-March 2020 and April- June 2020.

1.6.2 The Statements (in Chapter Three) and Tables (in Appendix A) of this report contain estimates of labour force indicators in *usual status* (*ps+ss*) and *current weekly status* (*CWS*). This report also covers some aspects of earnings from employment, hours worked, etc.

1.6.3 In the table below, the data reference of different Statements/ Tables of this Report are given. Estimates in this report correspond to the data collected in the entire survey period July 2019 to June 2020 or for each of the four quarters of the survey period (July-September

2019, October-December 2019, January-March 2020 and April- June 2020). The reference period of the estimates of a particular survey period (for example for a specific quarter or for the entire survey period) is the mid-point of the corresponding survey period.

Table 2: Data reference of different Statement in Chapter Three / Tables in Appendix A of this Report				
Tables in Appendix A	Statements in Chapter Three	Data reference	Survey period	Relevant quarter of the financial year (FY)-2019-20/2020-21
Table 1 to Table 41, Table 48 to Table 56	Statements 1 to 16, 24 to 40	First visit samples for both rural and urban areas	July 2019- June 2020	Quarter 2, Quarter 3 and Quarter 4 of FY 2019-20 and Quarter 1 of FY 2020-21.
Table 42 to Table 47, Table 57 and Table 58	Statements 17 to 23	For rural areas: First visit samples For urban areas: the first visit as well as the revisit samples	July - September 2019	Quarter 2 of FY 2019-20
		For rural areas: First visit samples For urban areas: the first visit as well as the revisit samples	October – December 2019	Quarter 3 of FY 2019-20
		For rural areas: First visit samples For urban areas: the first visit as well as the revisit samples	January – March 2020	Quarter 4 of FY 2019-20
		For rural areas: First visit samples For urban areas: the first visit as well as the revisit samples	April – June 2020	Quarter 1 of FY 2020-21.
In rural areas, there was no revisit, so the quarterly estimates are based on the data collected only during the first visit				

1.7 Contents of the report

1.7.1 This report contains three chapters, including the present introductory chapter (Chapter One), and five appendices. Chapter Two describes the concepts and definitions of important terms used in the survey in connection with the various items covered in this report. The summary of findings is presented in Chapter Three. The detailed tables forming the basis of this report are presented in Appendix A. The RSEs of some of the estimates have been presented in Appendix B. In Appendix C, estimates of Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR), Worker Population Ratio (WPR), Unemployment Rate (UR) which are already released in the Quarterly Bulletin of PLFS are presented separately for each of the quarter covering the survey period July, 2019 – June, 2020. Appendix D gives a detailed description of the sample design and estimation procedure used for the survey. Appendix E gives a facsimile of the schedule (Schedule 10.4) canvassed in the Periodic Labour Force Survey.

1.7.2 It may also be noted that as the estimates in Tables/Statements are generally presented as ‘percentage distribution’ or rates ‘in per cent’, the figures are rounded off. Thus, while using the ratios from the survey results, it is to be noted that the accuracy of these derived aggregates will be limited to the number of significant digits available in such ratios. The estimates of the employment and unemployment characteristics have been presented in the report for all the States and UTs. While using the State/UT level estimates, it may be noted that the sample sizes for the smaller States/UTs may not be adequate enough for getting sufficiently reliable estimates for some of the employment and unemployment characteristics.

1.7.3 If there are no sample households/persons in a particular category, the estimates/estimated proportions of households/persons in that category appear as zero (0). Estimated numbers ‘in per cent’ are also shown as zero (0), when they are greater than 0 but less than 0.05. While presenting the estimates in this report, transgender has been included in males. In the Statements/Tables where estimates are presented in percentages/percentage distributions, these are obtained by excluding not reported (n.r.) cases.

Chapter Two

Concepts and Definitions

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Chapter Two

Concepts and Definitions

2.0 In respect of the selected households, the information in this survey was collected through personal interview of the respondent(s). The concepts and definitions of some important terms used in the survey and relevant to this report are explained in the following paragraphs.

2.1 Household and household size: A group of persons who normally lived together and took food from a common kitchen constituted a household. The adverb “normally” means that temporary visitors and guests (whose total period of stay in the household was expected to be less than 6 months) were excluded but temporary stay-aways (whose total period of absence from the household was expected to be less than 6 months) were included. Thus a child residing in a hostel for studies was excluded from the household of his/her parents, but a resident domestic servant or paying guest (but not just a tenant in the house) was included in the employer’s/host’s household. “Living together” was given more importance than “sharing food from a common kitchen” in drawing the boundaries of a household in case the two criteria were in conflict. However, in the special case of a person taking food with his family but sleeping elsewhere (say, in a shop or a different house) due to shortage of space, the household formed by such a person’s family members was taken to include the person also. Each inmate of a hotel, mess, boarding-lodging house, hostel, etc., was considered to be a single-member household. The same principle was applicable for the residential staff of such establishments. However, if a group of persons among them pooled their income for spending, they were treated as forming a single household. A family living in a hotel was treated as a single household. The size of a household is the total number of persons in the household.

2.2 Age (years): The age in completed years, as on the date of survey, of the household members were recorded.

2.3 Household type: The household type was decided based on the sources of the household’s income during the 365 days preceding the date of survey. For this purpose, only the household’s income (net income and not gross income) from economic activities was considered; but the incomes of servants and paying guests were not taken into account.

In **rural** areas, a household belonged to any one of the following six household types:

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1. self-employed in agriculture | 5. casual labour in non-agriculture |
| 2. self-employed in non-agriculture | 6. others |
| 3. regular wage/salary earning | |
| 4. casual labour in agriculture | |

For **urban** areas, the household types are:

1. self-employed
2. regular wage/salary earning
3. casual labour
4. others

2.4 Household's usual consumer expenditure (in Rs.) in a month: This may was ascertained as follows.

(i) first it was ascertained what was the usual expenditure for household purposes in a month (let it was Rs. A).

(ii) Next, the purchase value of any household durables (mobile phones, TV sets, fridge, fans, cooler, AC, vehicles, computers, furniture, kitchen equipment, etc.) purchased during the *last one year* was ascertained and the expenditure *per month* was obtained by dividing by 12. (let it was Rs. B.)

(iii) Further, it was ascertained whether there was usually any consumption from (a) wages in kind (b) home-grown stock (c) free collection. If so, the approximate monthly value of the amount usually consumed in a month was imputed (Let it was Rs. C).

(iv) Then the sum of A+B+C was the usual monthly consumer expenditure of the household

2.5 General educational level: A person who can both read and write a simple message with understanding in at least one language was considered as literate for the purpose of the survey. For all the individuals who were found to be literate, the general level of education was collected in terms of highest level of education successfully completed by him/her. Highest level of education successfully completed by each member of the household was decided by considering his/ her all general/ technical/ vocational educational level and was recorded in terms of 12 categories viz. (i) *not literate*, (ii) *literate without formal schooling: (a) Education Guarantee Scheme (EGS)/Non-formal Education Courses (NFEC)/ Adult Literacy Centres (AEC), (b) Total Literacy Campaign (TLC), (c) others;* (iii) *literate but below primary*, (iv) *primary* (v) *middle*, (vi) *secondary*, (vii) *higher secondary*, (viii) *diploma/certificate course*, (ix) *graduate*, and (x) *postgraduate and above*. The criteria for deciding primary, middle, secondary, etc. levels were the same as that has been followed in the concerned states/union territories. The category 'diploma or certificate course' meant diploma or certificate courses in general education, technical education or vocational education, which is below graduation level. Diploma or certificate courses in general education, technical education or vocational education, which is equivalent to graduation level, was considered under the category 'graduate'. Similarly, diploma or certificate courses in general education, technical education or vocational education, which is equivalent to post-graduation level and above were considered under the category 'post-graduate and above'.

2.6 Number of years in formal education: Number of years in formal education refers to the number of academic years a person attended, or participated in a formal education programme (structured in terms of learning objectives, learning time or learning support and leading to degree/diploma/certificate) provided by elementary and secondary schools, universities, colleges and other institutions providing general/technical/vocation education, like polytechnics, ITIs, etc. An academic year was equivalent to a school year or in case of semester system, all the years in which semesters were planned. Entry in this column will be recorded in whole number of years by collecting the information on completed number of academic years spent in attending formal education. It may be noted that It may be noted that

- (i) Years in education at the level of pre-primary education was not included. Thus, years in school in kindergarten or such preparatory schooling were excluded. The count starts when the child gets admission in class I.
- (ii) No distinction was made in recording the years in education among students attending institutions providing automatic promotion and those allowing repetition in the same grade/class. Thus, in reporting the number of years in education, the repetition years were also counted.
- (iii) If a person had discontinued education at any time and again started education afterwards, then the time spent in-between was not counted.
- (iv) In counting the years in formal education, training programmes which are normally for performing specific jobs, in-service trainings was not included. However, the trainings which are part of the formal education programmes were considered for counting number of years in education.
- (v) There are some courses, like distance education, chartered accountancy (CA), Company Secretariatship (CS), etc., for which there is no fixed/predetermined number of years of education and one can complete such courses in phased manner in a number of attempts. For such courses, the following procedure was followed:
 - For those pursuing distance education, CA, CS, etc., number of years in education for that particular course was considered only when the course was completed successfully and it referred to the scheduled number of years generally specified or known for completion of the course.
 - In case, for a particular course, say, Doctorate, the number of years specified for completion of the course is not known, the number of years in education for such courses was considered only when the course was completed successfully. In such cases, calculation of number of years in education was done as follows: First determine the number of years in education for all such courses for which duration is known and then add two (2) years for each of courses completed for which number of years of education is not known. Thus, when a person completes chartered accountancy course, after completion of graduation, the number of years in education for that person will be the number of years in education for completing graduation level *plus* 2 years.

2.7 Technical educational level: The highest level of technical education successfully completed by each member of the household was recorded in terms of 16 categories viz. (i) *no technical education, technical degree in:* (ii) *agriculture, (iii) engineering/technology, (iv) medicine, (v) crafts, (vi) other subjects, diploma or certificate (below graduate level) in:* (vii) *agriculture, (viii) engineering/technology, (ix) medicine, (x) crafts, (xi) other subjects, diploma or certificate (graduate and above level) in:* (xii) *agriculture, (xiii) engineering/technology, (xiv) medicine, (xv) crafts, (xvi) other subjects*

2.8 Vocational/ Technical Training: A vocational/ technical training can broadly be defined as training through which knowledge and skills for the world of work were acquired. The main objective of vocational/ technical education and training is to make individuals employable for a broad range of occupations in various industries and other economic sectors. There are three methods of acquiring Vocational/ Technical training:

2.8.1 Formal Training: The training that is acquired through institutions/ organisations and is recognised by national certifying bodies, leading to diplomas/ certificates and qualifications. Formal training is structured according to educational arrangements such as curricula, qualifications, teaching/ learning requirements and assessment. Formal training is intentional from the learner's perspective.

2.8.2 Non- formal Training: The training that is in addition or alternative to formal learning and is also structured but is more flexible. It is provided through community-based settings, the workplace, or through the activities of civil society organisations or any organisation imparting training. This training mode does not have the level of curriculum, syllabus or accreditation and certification associated with formal learning but it is more structured as compared to informal learning.

2.8.3 Informal Training: The training that occurs in daily life, in the family, in the workplace, in communities, and through the interests and activities of individuals. It is not structured (in terms of learning objectives, learning time or learning support) and typically does not lead to certification.

2.8.4 Vocational/technical training other than formal vocational/technical training

(a) **Hereditary:** The expertise in a vocation or trade is sometimes acquired by the succeeding generations from the other members of the households, generally the ancestors. The expertise gained through significant 'hands-on' experience enables the individual to take up activities in self-employment capacity or makes them employable. Acquiring such marketable expertise by one, which enables him/her to carry out the trade or occupation of their ancestors over generations, was considered to be training through 'hereditary' sources.

(b) **Self-learning:** The expertise in a vocation or trade when acquired by a person through his/her own effort, without any training under any person or organisation, was considered as non-formal vocational training through 'self-learning'. For example, a person who learnt photography

on his own effort was considered to have acquired the non-formal vocational training through 'self-learning'.

(c) **Learning on the job:** The expertise acquired by a person while in employment (current and/or past), either through informal training by the employer or organisation or through the exposure to the type of job that he/she is/was performing, was considered as the training through 'learning on the job'. Note that if a person was provided with formal training in a vocation or trade even by the employer or organisation, while in employment, he/she was considered to have received 'formal' vocational/technical training.

(d) **Other:** The 'other' sources included the cases where the expertise for a vocation or trade was developed even from the household members or ancestors, provided that the said vocation or trade was different from the one relating to their ancestors. Similarly, a person might have learnt tailoring work from a master tailor or a person may learn book-binding work from a printing press. All such expertise acquired was considered as vocational/technical training through 'other' sources.

2.9 Economic activity: The entire spectrum of human activity falls into two categories – economic activities and non-economic activities. Any activity resulting in production of goods and services that add value to national product was considered as an economic activity for the employment and unemployment survey. Such activities included (i) production of all goods and services for market (i.e. for pay or profit) including those of government services, (ii) production of primary commodities for own consumption and (iii) own account production of fixed assets.

2.9.1 The full spectrum of economic activities as defined in the UN System of National Accounts was not covered in the definition of economic activities adopted for the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS). Although production of any good for own consumption is considered as economic activity by UN System of National Accounts, production of only primary goods for own consumption was considered as economic activity by NSSO for the purpose of the survey. While the former considers activities like own account processing of primary products as economic activities, processing of primary products for own consumption was not considered as economic activity for PLFS.

2.9.2 The term 'economic activity' as defined in the PLFS, therefore, included:

- (i) all the market activities performed for pay or profit which result in production of goods and services for exchange.
- (ii) of the non-market activities,
 - (a) all the activities relating to the agriculture, forestry, fishing, mining and quarrying sector (i.e. industry Divisions 01 to 09 of NIC-2008) which result in production of

primary goods for own consumption (including free collection of uncultivated crops, forestry, firewood, hunting, fishing, mining, quarrying, etc.)

and

(b) activities relating to the own-account production of fixed assets, which include production of fixed assets including construction of own houses, roads, wells, etc., and of machinery, tools, etc., for household enterprise and also construction of any private or community facilities free of charge. A person may be engaged in own account construction in the capacity of either a labour or a supervisor.

The activities like prostitution, begging, etc., which might result in earning, were not considered as economic activities for the survey.

2.10 Activity status: It is the activity situation in which a person was found during a specified reference period with regard to the person's participation in economic and non-economic activities. According to this, a person could be in one or a combination of the following three broad activity statuses during the reference period:

- (i) working or being engaged in economic activity (work),
- (ii) being not engaged in economic activity (work) but either making tangible efforts to seek 'work' or being available for 'work' if 'work' is available and
- (iii) being not engaged in any economic activity (work) and also not available for 'work'.

Broad activity statuses mentioned in (i) and (ii) above are associated with 'being in labour force' and the last with 'not being in the labour force'. Within the labour force, broad activity status (i) and (ii) were associated with 'employment' and 'unemployment', respectively.

2.10.1 Identification of each individual in terms of a unique activity status could pose a problem when more than one of the three broad activity statuses listed above were concurrently obtained for a person during the reference period. In such an eventuality, unique identification under any one of the three broad activity statuses (viz. employed/ unemployed/not in labour force) was done by adopting either *the major time criterion* or *priority criterion*. The former was used for classification of persons according to the usual status approach and the latter for classification of persons according to the current status approach (i.e., current weekly status and current daily status approaches).

Each of the three broad activity statuses was further sub-divided into several detailed activity categories. If a person categorised as engaged in economic activity was found to be pursuing more than one economic activity during the reference period, the appropriate detailed activity in terms of status and industry was considered as that one corresponding to which relatively long time had been spent. A similar procedure was adopted for assigning detailed activity code for

persons categorised as engaged in non-economic activity and pursuing more than one non-economic activity.

2.10.2 The detailed activity statuses under each of the three broad activity statuses (viz. 'employed', 'unemployed' and 'not in labour force') and the corresponding codes used in the survey are given below:

<u>code</u>	<u>description</u>
working (or employed)	
<i>self-employed</i>	
11	worked in household enterprises (self-employed) as own-account worker
12	worked in household enterprises (self-employed) as an employer
21	worked in household enterprises (self-employed) as helper
<i>regular wage/ salaried employee</i>	
31	worked as regular wage/salaried employee
<i>casual labour</i>	
41	worked as casual labour in public works other than MGNREG public works
42	worked as casual labour in Mahatma Gandhi NREG public works
51	worked as casual labour in other types of works
61	did not work owing to sickness though there was work in household enterprise
62	did not work owing to other reasons though there was work in household enterprise
71	did not work owing to sickness but had regular salaried/wage employment
72	did not work owing to other reasons but had regular salaried/wage employment
not working but seeking/available for work (or unemployed)	
81	sought work or did not seek but was available for work (for usual status approach)
81	sought work (for current weekly status approach)
82	did not seek but was available for work (for current weekly status approach)
neither working nor available for work (or not in labour force)	
91	attended educational institutions
92	attended to domestic duties only
93	attended to domestic duties and was also engaged in free collection of goods (vegetables, roots, firewood, cattle feed, etc.), sewing, tailoring, weaving, etc. for household use
94	rentiers, pensioners, remittance recipients, etc.
95	not able to work owing to disability
97	others (including beggars, prostitutes, etc.)
98	did not work owing to sickness (for casual workers only)
99	children of age 0-4 years

It may be noted that codes 42, 61, 62, 71, 72, 82 and 98 were applicable for current status only. It may also be noted that activity status code 41 in the usual status is used for casual labour in all types of public works, whereas in the current activity status, code 41 is for casual labour in public works other than MGNREG public works and code 42 is for casual labour in MGNREG public works.

2.11 Workers (or employed): Persons who were engaged in any economic activity or who, despite their attachment to economic activity, abstained themselves from work for reason of illness, injury or other physical disability, bad weather, festivals, social or religious functions or other contingencies necessitating temporary absence from work, constituted workers. Unpaid household members who assisted in the operation of an economic activity in the household farm or non-farm activities were also considered as workers. Relevant activity status codes 11 to 72 were assigned for workers. Workers were further categorized as *self-employed* (relevant activity status codes: 11, 12, 21, 61, 62), *regular wage /salaried employee* (relevant activity status codes: 31, 71, 72), and *casual labour* (relevant activity status codes: 41, 42 and 51).

2.12 Seeking or available for work (or unemployed): Persons who, owing to lack of work, had not worked but either sought work through employment exchanges, intermediaries, friends or relatives or by making applications to prospective employers or expressed their willingness or availability for work under the prevailing conditions of work and remuneration, were considered as those 'seeking or available for work' (or unemployed). Activity status codes 81 or 82 were assigned for unemployed.

2.13 Labour force: Persons who were either 'working' (or employed) or 'seeking or available for work' (or unemployed) constituted the labour force. Persons with activity status codes 11 – 82 constituted the labour force.

2.14 Not in labour force: Persons who were neither 'working' nor 'seeking or available for work' for various reasons during the reference period were considered as 'not in labour force'. Persons under this category are students, those engaged in domestic duties, rentiers, pensioners, recipients of remittances, those living on alms, infirm or disabled persons, too young persons, prostitutes, etc. and casual labours not working due to sickness. Activity status codes 91-95, 97, 98 and 99 were assigned for persons belonging to category 'not in labour force'.

2.15 Self-employed: Persons who operated their own farm or non-farm enterprises or were engaged independently in a profession or trade on own-account or with one or a few partners were deemed to be self-employed in household enterprises. The essential feature of the self-employed is that they have *autonomy* (decide how, where and when to produce) and *economic independence* (in respect of choice of market, scale of operation and finance) for carrying out

their operation. The remuneration of the self-employed consists of a non-separable combination of two parts: a reward for their labour and profit of their enterprise.

2.15.1 Categories of self-employed persons: Self-employed persons were further categorised as follows:

- (i) **own-account workers:** Self-employed persons who operated their enterprises on their own account or with one or a few partners and who, during the reference period, by and large, ran their enterprise without hiring any labour were considered as own-account workers. They could, however, have had unpaid helpers to assist them in the activity of the enterprise.
- (ii) **employers:** Self-employed persons who worked on their own account or with one or a few partners and, who, by and large, ran their enterprise by hiring labour were considered as employers.
- (iii) **helpers in household enterprise:** Self-employed persons who were engaged in their household enterprises, working full or part time and did not receive any regular salary or wages in return for the work performed were considered as helpers in household enterprise. They did not run the household enterprise on their own but assisted the concerned person living in the same household in running the household enterprise.

2.16 Regular wage/salaried employee: These were persons who worked in others' farm or non-farm enterprises (both household and non-household) and, in return, received salary or wages on a regular basis (i.e. not on the basis of daily or periodic renewal of work contract). This category included not only persons getting time wage but also persons receiving piece wage or salary and paid apprentices, both full time and part-time.

2.17 Casual labour: A person who was casually engaged in others' farm or non-farm enterprises (both household and non-household) and, in return, received wages according to the terms of the daily or periodic work contract, was considered as a casual labour.

2.18 Public works: 'Public works' were those activities which were sponsored by Government or Local Bodies, and which cover local area development works like construction of roads, dams, bunds, digging of ponds, etc., as relief measures, or as an outcome of employment generation schemes under the poverty alleviation programmes such as Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee (MGNREG) works, Sampoorna Grameen Rozgar Yojana (SGRY), National Food for Work Programme (NFFWP), etc. The coverage of schemes under 'public works' is restricted to those schemes under poverty alleviation programmes, or relief measures through which the Government generated wage employment. The types of works that were generally undertaken through these schemes, were watershed development, drought proofing, land levelling, flood control, laying pipes or cables, sanitation, water harvesting, digging of irrigation canal, development of orchard, road construction, building construction /

repair, running crèche, etc. There may be some schemes sponsored by the Government and in operation, which were conceived as self-employment generation schemes. Some such schemes of the Government were Swarnjayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana (schemes under erstwhile IRDP merged with this), Rural Employment Generation Programme (REGP), Prime Minister's Rozgar Yojana (PMRY), Valmiki Ambedkar Awas Yojana (VAMBAY), etc. Employment generated through these schemes was not considered within the purview of 'public works'. Classification of individuals as 'casual labour in public works' required that the work in which they participated was 'public works' as defined above. To distinguish between 'public works' and works not classifiable as 'public works', some broad characteristics of 'public works' were identified, viz. the primary objective was generation of wage employment and poverty alleviation, and creation of community asset as an outcome in achieving those main objectives. It is to be noted that for assigning current weekly and current daily activity status codes for the casual labour working in public works, codes 41 and 42 were used as follows:

- (i) worked as casual labour in public works other than Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee (MGNREG) public works – 41
- (ii) worked as casual labour in Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee (MGNREG) public works – 42

In the usual activity status, code 41 was used for casual labour in public works, which included all types of public works and code 42 was not applicable in the usual activity status.

2.19 Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA): The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005 (MGNREGA) is an important step towards the realization of the right to work and to enhance the livelihood security of the households in the rural areas of the country. According to this Act, Rural Employment Guarantee Schemes (REGS) are formed by the State Governments. The Scheme provides at least 100 days of guaranteed wage employment in every financial year to every household whose adult members volunteer to do unskilled manual work. Adult means a person who has completed his/ her eighteen years of age. Unskilled manual work means any physical work which any adult person is capable of doing without any special skill/ training. The implementing agency of the scheme may be any Department of the Central Government or a State Government, a Zila Parishad, Panchayat/ Gram Panchayat or any local authority or Government undertaking or non-governmental organization authorized by the Central Government or the State Government.

2.20 Different approaches for determining activity status: In the labour force surveys, the activity status of a person is determined on the basis of the activities pursued by the person during certain specified reference period. The activity status determined on the basis of the reference period of last 365 days preceding the date of survey is known as the usual activity status of the person, that determined on the basis of a reference period of last 7 days preceding the date of survey is known as the current weekly status (CWS) of the person and the activity status determined for each day of the reference week which is known as the current daily status

(CDS) of the person. For the PLFS, activity status was collected for all the three reference periods mentioned above, viz., last 365 days for usual status, using a reference period of 7 days preceding the date of the survey for current weekly status and each day of the reference week for current daily status.

2.20.1 Identification of each individual into a unique situation poses a problem when more than one of three types of broad activity status viz. 'employed', 'unemployed' and 'not in labour force' is concurrently obtained for a person. In such an eventuality, unique identification under any one of the three broad activity statuses was done by adopting either the major time criterion or priority criterion. The former was used for classification of persons under 'usual activity status' and, the latter, for classification of persons under 'current weekly status' and 'current daily status'. If, by adopting one of these two criteria, a person categorised as engaged in economic activity was found to be pursuing more than one economic activity during the reference period, the appropriate detailed activity status category related to the activity in which relatively more time was spent. Similar approach was adopted for non-economic activities also.

2.20.2 Usual activity status: The usual activity status relates to the activity status of a person during the reference period of 365 days preceding the date of survey. The activity status on which a person spent relatively long time (major time criterion) during the 365 days preceding the date of survey was considered the *usual principal activity status* of the person. To decide the usual principal activity of a person, he/ she was first categorised as belonging to the labour force or not, during the reference period on the basis of major time criterion. Persons, thus adjudged as not belonging to the labour force were assigned the broad activity status 'neither working nor available for work'. For the persons belonging to the labour force, the broad activity status of either 'working' or 'not working but seeking and/ or available for work' was then ascertained again on the basis of the relatively long time spent in the labour force during the 365 days preceding the date of survey. Within the broad activity status so determined, the detailed activity status category of a person pursuing more than one such activity was determined again on the basis of the 'relatively long time spent' criterion.

2.20.3 Subsidiary economic activity status: Usual principal status of a person was determined as the status on which the person spent relatively long time (major time criterion) during the 365 days preceding the date of survey. Such persons might have also pursued, in addition to his/her usual principal status, some economic activity for 30 days or more during the reference period of 365 days preceding the date of survey. The status in which such economic activity was pursued during the reference period of 365 days preceding the date of survey was the subsidiary economic activity status of the person. In case of multiple subsidiary economic activities, the major activity and status based on the 'relatively long time spent' criterion was considered. It may be noted that engagement in work in subsidiary capacity may arise out of the two following situations: